then look up all of user's messages that are newer or older than a specific timestamp, and the items would be sorted according to the timestamp.

12.8 SQL-like queries with PartiQL

As the developer of nodetodo, we want to get some insight into the way our users use the application. Therefore, we are looking for a flexible approach to query the data stored on DynamoDB on the fly.

Because SQL is such a widely used language, hardly any database system can avoid offering an SQL interface as well, even if, in the case of NoSQL databases, often only a fraction of the language is supported. In the following examples, you will learn how to use PartiQL, which is designed to provide unified query access to all kinds of data and data stored. DynamoDB supports PartiQL via the Management Console, NoSQL Workbench, AWS CLI, and DynamoDB APIs. Be aware that DynamoDB supports only a small subset of the PartiQL language. The following query lists all tasks stored in table `todo-task`:

```
$ aws dynamo3db execute-statement \                ①
➥ --statement "SELECT * FROM \""todo-task\""""     ②
```

① The command execute-statement supports PartiQL statements as well.

② A simple SELECT statement to fetch all attributes of all items from table todo-task. The escaped " is required because the table name includes a hyphen.

PartiQL allows you to query an index as well. The following statement fetches all tasks with category equals `shopping` from index `category-index`: